

Ultimate Nutrition's

L-5-HYDROXYTRYPTOPHAN

Despite being used to regular exercise and physical activity, it is possible to experience bodily aches and pains, particularly if muscle are not entirely recovered, which can lead to insomnia and even migraine-like headaches. L-5-Hydroxytryptophan (5HTP), a derivative of the amino acid tryptophan, is the remedy that allows the body to recover from exhaustion and to rebuild itself naturally.

5-HTP is converted to serotonin, which is a neurotransmitter. A neurotransmitter is a chemical messenger that relays information from one nerve cell to the next. Serotonin is a vital compound that is produced in the brain by the amino acid tryptophan. 5-HTP is one step closer to the production of serotonin. Serotonin affects many different parts of the brain, and has been correctly regarded as the body's own mood elevating and calming substance. A few clinical studies have reported that 5-HTP administration relieves nonspecific, general pain in the body effectively.

Aches and pains in the body can cause restlessness, which may cause lack of sleep. Serotonin is an important initiator of sleep. Tryptophan is known to induce sleep by increasing the amounts of serotonin. It is also well established that 5-HTP is a more effective inducer of serotonin and, hence, a better sleep initiator. In fact, 5-HTP has the unique ability to increase the deep and restful sleep by as much as 25%.

There is good evidence to support the role of 5-HTP in relieving migraines and general headaches. In addition to increasing serotonin levels, 5-HTP also increases endorphin levels, which typically are low in those suffering from migraine and persistent headaches.

It is important to note that 5-HTP also helps in reducing weight. By increasing serotonin levels in the brain, 5-HTP increases the "feeling of satisfaction," leading to consumption of fewer calories at mealtimes.

5-HTP is not just for the athletes, however, or those with migraines and nondescript pains. It is a nutrient that has superior benefits for just about everyone. It induces restful sleep and, therefore, increases energy and productivity in general.

SELECTED REFERENCES

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FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

1 What Other Nutrients Should Be Taken with 5-HTP?

It is important to maintain adequate levels of vitamin B6, niacin and magnesium when taking 5-HTP, since these are essential cofactors in the conversion of 5-HTP to serotonin.

2 Why Prefer 5-HTP To Tryptophan?

Presently, tryptophan is available only by prescription. Since 5-HTP is one step closer to conversion to serotonin, it is a better choice.

3 What Is The Best Time to Take 5-HTP?

The sedative effects of 5-HTP can be enhanced by taking it near bedtime with a carbohydrate source such as fruit or fruit juice. 5-HTP should not be taken before driving, undertaking any physical activity or operating heavy machinery.

4 Can 5-HTP Also Help Manage Fibromyalgia?

Clinical studies have shown that fibromyalgia may respond to nutritional management with 5-HTP. When used in clinical studies, improvements were observed in several areas such as the number of painful areas, morning stiffness, sleep pattern, anxiety and fatigue.

5 What Are The Contraindications?

As a nutritional supplement, 5-HTP should not be taken with any antidepressant without consulting with the prescribing physician.